

Finding Apex Fintech's Chicago connection

Account entry plan for Spencer Refer | Prepared Thursday, October 1, 2026 | Sources: HubSpot, Lemlist, ZoomInfo, Apollo

96 Colocation intent, audience B (Sep 12)	91 Data Center intent, audience B (Sep 12)	6 Apex contacts in Wave B, 0 replies	~950 employees, growing ~8% a year
STAGE Wave B prospect. No deal.	RUNNING NOW CTF ABM - Apex Fintech (Wave B), 6 leads	LAST TOUCH Sep 23-24: email 2 to 5 leads	NEXT STEP Mon Oct 5: email Philip Howell (Director, Platform Infrastructure)

Bottom line

Apex is the clearing and custody engine behind many retail brokerages, headquartered in Dallas. On Sep 12 ZoomInfo showed it researching **Colocation (96)** and **Data Center (91)**, both strong and network-relevant. It is also adding new venues: Gemini's CFTC-regulated prediction markets now run through Apex's futures business (Aug 24). Nobody in your Wave B list owns infrastructure spend; they are IT operations and network engineers. The person who does is **Philip Howell, Director of Platform Infrastructure** (promoted Mar 2025), and the CTO, **Frank Tiemann, ran technology at Ronin Capital, a Chicago trading firm**. The plan is to ask Howell how Apex reaches Chicago's futures markets.

What Apex is, in one analogy

Apex is the back kitchen behind dozens of restaurant brands: the brokerages have the storefronts, Apex cooks and delivers. When the kitchen adds a new cuisine (futures, crypto event contracts), it needs new supply routes, and Chicago is where futures supply comes from.

Signals worth citing

Signal	Source	So what for the opener
Colocation intent 96 and Data Center intent 91 (audience B), Sep 12, 2026	ZoomInfo intent	Active facility research, matching your offer.
Gemini to be the exclusive CFTC-regulated venue for crypto event contracts through Apex's FCM (Aug 24, 2026)	ZoomInfo news	New futures flows. Futures clearing tends to mean Chicago connectivity.
Hiring a VP, Head of Operations in Dallas (Sep 16)	ZoomInfo scoop	Operations leadership change. Context only.
Frank Tiemann, CTO since 2020, was CTO of Ronin Capital (Chicago)	Apollo	Knows the Chicago trading ecosystem. Executive air cover later.
Philip Howell promoted to Director, Platform Infrastructure (Mar 2025)	Apollo	The likely owner of hosting and connectivity design.

Work already in motion

When	Channel / campaign	What happened	Read
Sep 11-15	Wave B, visits + email 1	To Wallington, Luczkowiak, Midence, Varutharaju, Joe G.	No replies
Sep 16-17	Wave B, LinkedIn invites	To all 5	None accepted
Sep 21-24	Wave B, follow + email 2	'The part of your path map you can't see'	No replies
Sep 28	Wave B, new lead	Rishabh Parikh (Network Engineer) added	Step 1 skipped Sep 30
Sep 30	CTF ENT Leaders/Practitioners	Duplicates removed	Only in Wave B now
Oct 1	Wave B LinkedIn	A LinkedIn invite was accepted (step 3)	Opens a LinkedIn follow-up

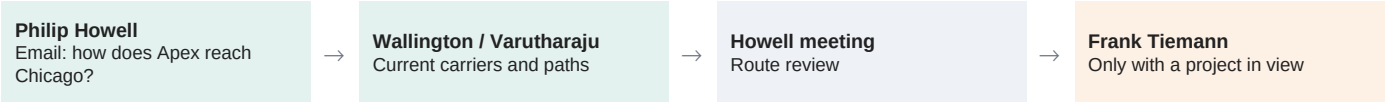
Who to reach, in order

Contact	Title (source)	Where	Why they matter	Status / email
Philip Howell	Director, Platform Infrastructure (Apollo)	Dallas	Owens platform hosting design.	Not contacted. phowell@apexfi ntechsolutions.com (verified)
Paul Wallington	Director, IT Operations (HubSpot)	Texas (972)	Runs IT operations; may own carrier contracts.	Wave B, no reply
Matt Luczkowiak	Director, IT Operations (HubSpot)	California (650)	Peer of Wallington.	Wave B, no reply
Sundar Varutharaju	Senior Network Engineer (HubSpot)	Texas (469)	Senior hands-on network engineer.	Wave B, no reply
Frank Tiemann	CTO (Apollo). Ex-CTO Ronin Capital, Chicago.	Portland, OR	Executive sponsor; Chicago trading background.	Not contacted; no verified email. Hold

Not worth chasing for this goal

Hector P. (Deputy CISO) and the cloud developers in Apollo are not network buyers. Joe G. (IT Manager) and Jose Midence stay in Wave B with no extra touches.

How the access path should run



Messages, by contact

1. Philip Howell Director, Platform Infrastructure

Why them: Likely owner; untouched.

Channel: Email Mon Oct 5; LinkedIn connect without a note | Subject: Apex's path to Chicago futures

Philip, with Apex's futures business growing (the Gemini event contracts, for one), I'm curious how Apex reaches the Chicago markets today: your own paths, or a provider's network? Crosstown owns underground dark fiber in Chicago. If you're reviewing colocation this year, worth 15 minutes?

2. Sundar Varutharaju Senior Network Engineer

Why them: Technical reply in the existing thread.

Channel: Email reply in Wave B thread, Wed Oct 7 | Subject: Re: the part of your path map you can't see

Sundar, one quick one. For Apex's Chicago connectivity, are the two paths verified diverse at the conduit level or by carrier attestation? I keep finding overlap that nobody knew about, and I'm happy to show you our map either way.

The plan

When	Move	Notes
Fri Oct 2	Pause Varutharaju in Wave B.	-
Mon Oct 5	Email Philip Howell; add him to HubSpot.	-
Wed Oct 7	Reply to Varutharaju in thread.	-
Mon Oct 12	Call Paul Wallington (972 number in Lemlist).	Ask who owns carrier contracts.
Week of Oct 19	Follow-up to Howell with a Chicago map.	-
Week of Oct 26	Goal: 20-minute call with Howell.	If Apex has no Chicago footprint, move to nurture.

What progress looks like (for management)

By	Milestone	How we will know
Oct 16	Know whether Apex has a Chicago network footprint	HubSpot note
Oct 30	Conversation with Howell	Call or meeting logged

Guardrails

- Don't assume Apex colocates in Chicago; ask.
- Credits used: 2 Apollo person enrichments; ZoomInfo company and signals for 1 company.

Sources

HubSpot contacts and notes; Lemlist 'CTF ABM - Apex Fintech (Wave B)'; ZoomInfo intent (Sep 12), scoops (Sep 7, 16) and news (Gemini Aug 24; Benzinga Apr 28; Allfunds Jan 17, 2026); Apollo people and organization data (Oct 1, 2026).